

Poetry

Poetry Study
Poetry Reading





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Poetry Study: Grade 7, Poetry Reading: Grade 7

About Poetry Study: Grade 7

Students study poetic devices and forms and practice writing poetry themselves.

About Poetry Reading: Grade 7

Students continue to develop their relationship with words through ongoing exposure to a variety of poetic forms, poet biographies, and 19th century poems.



Placement & Combining Tips

Poetry Reading: Grade 7

Students in Grades 5-8 can easily be combined for these lessons as all grades use nearly the same texts this year, although Grades 7-8 read additional selections and have corresponding composition assignments. Poetry lessons are also an integral part of the whole Literature program, so look at both literature and poetry selections together when placing students.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
7	Poetry Study: Grade 7 1 time/week 20 min	What Is Poetry?
7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7 4 times/week 5 min	A Kick in the Head: An Everyday Guide to Poetic Forms Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar The Poet: Pauline Johnson Over the River and Through the Wood: An Anthology of Nineteenth-Century American Children's Poetry The Crescent Moon

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Poetry: Grade 7				
Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Reading: Grade 7	Poetry Study: Grade 7



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Poetry Study: Grade 7

☐ Some of the poems are given as links or PDFs. You may want to print those out.

☐ Make sure the student has a Commonplace Book to write down any poems they especially enjoy. You will want to remind them to do that during poetry time, or set another time in the afternoon to do that.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Poetry: Grade 7

Poetry Study: Grade 7



What Is Poetry?

Poetry Reading: Grade 7



A Kick in the Head: An Everyday Guide to Poetic Forms



Jump Back, Paul: The Life and Poems of Paul Laurence Dunbar



The Poet: Pauline Johnson



Over the River and Through the Wood: An Anthology of Nineteenth-Century American Children's Poetry



The Crescent Moon



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Poetry: Grade 7

Poetry Reading: Grade 7

∞ [Over the River Public Domain Poetry List](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Poetry: Grade 7

How To Teach



Introduce

Tell something about the poet or the kind of poem or fable to prepare students. Remember that poems are like paintings—they not only convey ideas, they create an experience with the sound of words, the way the words are arranged, and the emotions, thoughts, and images they evoke.



Read

Read the poem aloud in order to hear the sounds and meter. Have students read it aloud as well as it is helpful to hear poetry read by different voices. Try to read paying attention to the punctuation as well as the line breaks to get the sense of the poem.



Discuss

Allow students to share any thoughts or connections. What are your impressions of the poem? Talk about anything that stood out to you: the images, ideas, words, phrases, sounds, or even physical look of the poem. What kinds of things is the poem about?



Reread

Read (or have the student read) the poem again.



Connect

Students may choose to add poems to their Commonplace Book or mark them to copy later.

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ INTRO

What makes something a poem? Let's explore this question in our book by British poet, Poet Laureate (2007-2009), and author Michael Rosen.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Suggest Things Ch.1 p.1-6

- Rosen writes, "They don't try to give us answers. They leave us to do a lot of the figuring out." Read the poem below and ask questions about it and what it might be saying. You don't have to know the answers.

"The Listeners"

By Walter De La Mare

'Is there anybody there?' said the Traveller,
Knocking on the moonlit door;
And his horse in the silence champed the grasses
Of the forest's ferny floor:
And a bird flew up out of the turret,
Above the Traveller's head:
And he smote upon the door again a second time;
'Is there anybody there?' he said.
But no one descended to the Traveller;
No head from the leaf-fringed sill
Leaned over and looked into his grey eyes,
Where he stood perplexed and still.
But only a host of phantom listeners
That dwelt in the lone house then
Stood listening in the quiet of the moonlight
To that voice from the world of men:
Stood thronging the faint moonbeams on the dark stair,
That goes down to the empty hall,
Harkening in an air stirred and shaken
By the lonely Traveller's call.
And he felt in his heart their strangeness,
Their stillness answering his cry,
While his horse moved, cropping the dark turf,
'Neath the starred and leafy sky;
For he suddenly smote on the door, even
Louder, and lifted his head:—
'Tell them I came, and no one answered,
That I kept my word,' he said.
Never the least stir made the listeners,
Though every word he spake
Fell echoing through the shadowiness of the still house
From the one man left awake:
Ay, they heard his foot upon the stirrup,
And the sound of iron on stone,
And how the silence surged softly backward,
When the plunging hoofs were gone.

WEEK 1 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 1

Materials: A Kick in the Head

→ INTRO

Would you enjoy sports if there were no rules? Why is it good to have rules? What does that have to do with poetry? Let's find out.

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Introduction, Couplet p.8-11

Read the poem and the definition of that type of poem, and then reread the poem and tell how it follows or departs from that rule.

- How does the picture in the corner relate to the poetic form?
- Can you think of any famous couplets? Hint: Think of nursery rhymes.

→ WRITE

Put the term couplet and its definition in your notebook. You will be adding to this list each week. You should keep your notebook handy to look for these poetic devices as you read daily poetry.

WEEK 1 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Materials: Over the River and Through the Wood

→ NOTE

You will usually spend one week reading the poems from ~5 pages (depending on the size of the illustrations and length of poems). You can pick 1-3 to read each day and reread them as much as you like. Poetry is made to be read many times. Lessons give some ideas for discussing a particular poem, but those are only suggestions. You'll also focus particularly on getting to know the poets Rabindranath Tagore in Term 1, Pauline Johnson in Term 2, and Paul Laurence Dunbar in Term 3. Feel free to use the index of the book to look up other poems by poets you particularly like.

→ INTRO

Almost all the poems we'll read this year were written from 1800-1900 AD (the time period you'll learn about in many of your other lessons as well). So, as you read, imagine children like you listening to these same poems about 200 years ago! First, let's start by reading a poem that reminds us to enjoy (and not overthink) the poems we'll read this year.
∞ Link: Introduction To Poetry

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.31-36 Chapter: Growing Things

Pick and choose poems from these pages over the week.
(Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.)

★ TEACHER NOTE

Optional: Read the Introduction and share information with students throughout the year.

Note: The "Holidays" chapter of Over the River and Through the Wood is not scheduled until Term 3. Feel free to also read from that chapter during Thanksgiving, Christmas, New Year's, etc.

WEEK 1 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

Materials: Over the River and Through the Wood

→ INTRO

Our poem today is by Paul Laurence Dunbar. He was one of the first Black Americans to earn a living as a writer, and he inspired many other writers after him. He also became friends with Orville Wright and his brother Wilbur (who you may remember as the inventors of the airplane)! The Wright brothers owned a printing press and published Dunbar's first writings.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.36 "The Seedling" by Paul Laurence Dunbar

- Do you notice how the seedling starts talking in the poem? Have you ever heard a seedling talk? Of course not! Poets sometimes imagine that things like plants or animals can talk to help us think about them in new ways. The fancy word for this is "personification." Do you notice any other examples of the seed doing things only people normally do?
- Keep your eyes open for other poems this week that use personification.

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

What human traits do they give the trees or seeds? Look for examples in "Tree Feelings" by Charlotte Perkins Gilman on p.31.

→ NOTE

You'll read an interesting biography about Paul Laurence Dunbar in Term 3 that includes several more of his poems.

WEEK 1 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 4

Materials: Crescent Moon

→ INTRO

Rabindranath Tagore was born in 1861 in Calcutta, India, and grew up in a family that loved art, music, and ideas. He was a poet, short-story writer, composer, playwright, and painter who spent his life creating in many different ways. In 1913, he became the first non-European writer to be awarded the Nobel Prize for Literature. He also composed the national anthems for both India and Bangladesh, making his words a lasting part of two nations. Once a week this term, we'll read poems by Rabindranath Tagore, exploring themes like mothers, children, and nature.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.8 "On the Seashore"

- What are the children doing at the seashore?
- What might the "seashore of endless worlds" symbolize?

p.6-10

Pick and choose poems from these pages.

(Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.)

WEEK 2 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 2

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that a poem suggests things?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Give an Impression, Poetry Can Play With Words Ch.1 p.7-19

- How does the author, Eugene Field, play with words in the poem "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod"?
- ∞ Link: "Wynken, Blynken, and Nod"

WEEK 2 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 5

Materials: A Kick in the Head

→ RECAP

Do you remember what a couplet is?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Tercet p.12

Read the poem and the definition of that type of poem, and then reread the poem and tell how it follows or departs from that rule.

- How does the picture in the corner relate to the poetic form?

→ WRITE

Put the tercet and its definition in your notebook.

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 □ 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 6

□ Materials: Over the River and Through the Wood

→ INTRO

Our poet today is Ina Coolbrith. She was born Josephine Smith. Her uncle Joseph Smith was the founder of the Mormon church, and her father (who died when she was just a few months old) was a church leader, though she concealed this most of her life. Her ties to the church were severed in childhood when her mother remarried a non-Mormon, and they moved to California to follow the gold rush. She published her first poems as a teenager and worked for over two decades as a librarian, encouraging the writing careers of others. She became California's first Poet Laureate in 1915.

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.50 "In Blossom Time" by Ina Coolbrith

- "In Blossom Time" is written in quatrain, meaning each verse contains exactly four lines. Sometimes a whole poem is written in quatrain, as in this poem, and sometimes just part of the poem uses this structure. Quatrains usually have a specific rhyme structure. In this poem, the structure is ABCB, meaning that the words ending the second and fourth lines rhyme (B), but the first (A) and third (C) lines do not. Quatrains can have other rhyme structures, such as AABB or ABBA.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Ina Coolbrith Bio

WEEK 2 □ 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 7

□ Materials: Over the River and Through the Wood

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.45 "The Johnny Cake" Author Unknown

- "The Johnny Cake" has three lines per stanza, which is called a tercet. The pace of a tercet is often slower than a couplet or quatrain. What is the rhyme scheme?

p.44 "To Make A Prairie" by Emily Dickinson

- Notice "To Make A Prairie" is both very brief and uses an unconventional AAABB rhyme structure. Why might Dickinson have chosen this for her subject? Note that reverie means to daydream or be lost in imagination.

★ TEACHER NOTE

"The Johnny Cake" rhyme scheme is ABB.

WEEK 2 □ 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 8

□ Materials: Crescent Moon

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.12-13 "Sleep-Stealer"

- Do you think someone really stole the baby's sleep?
- What phrase is repeated throughout the poem? Why do you think this is?
- How does the poem blur the line between the real world and the imaginative world?

p.11-15

If time allows, pick and choose poems from these pages.
(Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.)

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 20m Poetry Study: Grade 7 - Lesson 3

Materials: What Is Poetry?

→ RECAP

What does it mean that a poem gives an impression?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Poetry Can Be Symbolic, Poetry Can Be Personal Ch.1 p.20-27

- Rosen said that "Tennyson has turned the eagle into a person and then into a symbol of power" (p.23). Giving animals or things feelings, ideas, and thoughts so they can behave in ways people behave is called personification. Read the poem "The Oven Bird" by Robert Frost. What kinds of feelings and thoughts is he giving to the bird? The oven bird's song is "teacher, teacher, teacher." Could the bird be teaching us a lesson?

∞ Link: "The Oven Bird"

∞ Video Link: Song of the Ovenbird

WEEK 3 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 9

Materials: A Kick in the Head

→ RECAP

Do you remember what a tercet is?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Quatrain p.13

Read the poem and the definition of that type of poem, and then reread it and tell how it follows or departs from that rule.

- How does the picture in the corner relate to the poetic form?
- Read the whole poem "The Tyger" by William Blake. What is the rhyme scheme?

Tyger Tyger, burning bright,
In the forests of the night;
What immortal hand or eye,
Could frame thy fearful symmetry?

In what distant deeps or skies.
Burnt the fire of thine eyes?
On what wings dare he aspire?
What the hand, dare seize the fire?

And what shoulder, & what art,
Could twist the sinews of thy heart?
And when thy heart began to beat.
What dread hand? & what dread feet?

What the hammer? what the chain,
In what furnace was thy brain?
What the anvil? what dread grasp.
Dare its deadly terrors clasp?

When the stars threw down their spears
And water'd heaven with their tears:
Did he smile his work to see?
Did he who made the Lamb make thee?

Tyger Tyger burning bright,

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

In the forests of the night:
What immortal hand or eye,
Dare frame thy fearful symmetry?

→ WRITE

Put the term quatrain and its definition in your notebook.

WEEK 3 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 10

Materials: Over the River and Through the Wood

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.58 "Give Me The Splendid Silent Sun" by Walt Whitman
(We'll learn more about Walt Whitman later in the year.)

- What examples of alliteration (repeated sounds) and/or repetition (repeated words) can you find in this poem?
- The poem in our book leaves out some lines. The verse ends like this:
These demanding to have them, (tired with ceaseless excitement,
and rack'd by the war-strife,)
These to procure incessantly asking, rising in cries from my heart,
While yet incessantly asking still I adhere to my city,
Day upon day and year upon year O city, walking your streets,
Where you hold me enchain'd a certain time refusing to give me
up,
Yet giving to make me glutted, enrich'd of soul, you give me
forever faces;
(O I see what I sought to escape, confronting, reversing my cries,
I see my own soul trampling down what it ask'd for.)
- This poem was written during the Civil War. In fact, Whitman volunteered as a nurse caring for wounded soldiers, and the experience inspired some of his most powerful poems. Knowing this, how does the line about being "rack'd by the war-strife" impact Whitman's longing for peaceful nature?

★ TEACHER NOTE

The full poem is split into two distinct parts — the first longing for nature and solitude, the second embracing the city. However, the second part does include content that may not be suitable for your students, so it is not included in the book or the lesson. Be sure to preview if you wish to share with your students.

• COMPOSITION

Knowing of Walt Whitman's experience as a Civil War nurse, how does the line about being "rack'd by the war-strife" impact Whitman's longing for peaceful nature?

WEEK 3 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 11

Materials: Over the River and Through the Wood

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.59 "A Day" Emily Dickinson

- We previously read Emily Dickinson's "To Make A Prairie" (p. 44), which used an unconventional rhyme structure. "A Day" includes a more traditional quatrain (four-line verse) and rhyme structure. Can you identify what that rhyme structure is?

★ TEACHER NOTE

"A Day" rhyme scheme is ABCB.

WEEK 3 5m Poetry Reading: Grade 7 - Lesson 12

Materials: Crescent Moon

→ READ & DISCUSS

p.19 "Playthings"

- How does the poem compare child's play to adult work, and which seems more satisfying?
- What "art" has the adult forgotten?
- What does the poem mean when it says adults spend their lives seeking "costly playthings"? Does this create success and happiness?

Poetry: Grade 7

[Click THIS text or
scan the QR code
for links.](#)



Term 1

p.16-19

If time allows, pick and choose poems from these pages.
(Read one time, discuss, and then reread the poems.)

SAMPLE